Practical AI for Industrial HR

Alternate Title:
Using Generative AI to Improve Candidate Discovery, Resume Review, and Business Efficiency in Industrial Organizations

Course Description

This continuing-education course prepares HR professionals, hiring managers, administrative staff, and operational leaders in industrial organizations to use generative AI as a practical workplace assistant.

The course emphasizes employee-directed AI assistance and collaboration rather than AI embedded within HR systems. Participants will explore practical ways to identify qualified candidates, improve resume review, prepare HR and business communications, reduce administrative workload, improve consistency, and shorten hiring timelines.

The course also addresses responsible AI use, including confidentiality, human oversight, bias, inaccurate output, privacy, and employment-related risk. Exercises use fictional or nonconfidential information and do not require access to employer HR systems.

Target Audience

The course is intended for current employees working in:

- Human resources and talent acquisition
- Administrative and office-support roles
- Manufacturing and production operations
- Logistics, warehousing, and transportation
- Construction and skilled trades
- Energy, utilities, and field services
- Workforce planning and organizational leadership

No advanced technical or AI experience is required.

Business Concerns Addressed

The course responds to several common workforce challenges:

- Qualified candidates being overlooked or lost during hiring
- Understaffed HR and administrative teams
- Excessive time and economic cost associated with current processes
- Inconsistent or inefficient candidate-review practices
- Increasing administrative demands on HR and office professionals
- Uncertainty about the appropriate and responsible use of AI

Levels of Workplace AI

Because AI terminology varies among organizations, the course uses three working classifications:

- **AI-Assisted:** AI supports a specific employee-directed task, such as drafting a job description, summarizing notes, or revising a communication. The employee controls the process and final result.

- **AI-Enabled Collaboration:** An employee works iteratively with an approved AI tool to brainstorm, organize, compare, evaluate, or refine workplace materials.

- **AI-Embedded:** AI is integrated directly into an HRIS, applicant tracking system, payroll platform, or another operational system. It may access organizational data, automate decisions, or initiate workflow actions.

This course focuses on **AI-assisted work and AI-enabled collaboration**. It is not intended to use, offer, recommend, or teach AI-embedded applications, HR-system integrations, automated employment decisions, or technical workflow development.

Course Structure

Primary Workshop: Approximately 3–4 Hours

The primary workshop consists of five focused instructional areas totaling **180–230 minutes**, or approximately **3 hours to 3 hours 50 minutes** of instructional time. At the upper end of the range, a 10-minute break creates a complete four-hour workshop. The three-hour format is more presentation-led, while the four-hour format allows additional time for guided practice and discussion.

1. **Industrial Hiring Challenges and Workplace AI — 30–40 minutes**
   Examine hiring delays, administrative workload, missed candidates, and their business effects. Introduce generative AI and distinguish among AI-assisted, AI-enabled collaboration, and AI-embedded applications. Establish the course's scope and boundaries.

2. **Writing Effective Prompts — 30–40 minutes**
   Apply a practical framework for communicating with AI, refining results, checking accuracy, and developing reusable prompts for HR and office tasks.

3. **Candidate Review and Practical Applications — 60–75 minutes**
   Explore AI-assisted resume review using fictional information and employer-provided job requirements and screening criteria. Activities include identifying potentially transferable skills and supporting consistent human review, along with preparing job descriptions, interview questions, onboarding materials, communications, meeting summaries, policy drafts, and administrative materials.

4. **Privacy, Risk, and Human Oversight — 30–35 minutes**
   Address confidentiality, personal information, bias, inaccurate output, organizational policies, appropriate review, and employee responsibility for final decisions and materials.

5. **Business Impact, Guided Practice, and Next Steps — 30–40 minutes**
   Complete a guided exercise using fictional or nonconfidential information, consider potential time and cost improvements, and identify one appropriate low-risk application for the participant's organization.

Expanded Program Option: Approximately 8 Hours

The expanded program provides additional time for instruction, demonstrations, practical exercises, facilitated discussion, and implementation planning. Its nine modules are:

1. **Industrial Hiring and Workforce Challenges**
   Examine hiring delays, administrative demands, missed candidates, and their operational and economic effects.

2. **Understanding Workplace AI**
   Introduce generative AI and distinguish among AI-assisted, AI-enabled, and AI-embedded applications.

3. **Writing Effective Prompts**
   Apply a practical framework for requesting, refining, and evaluating AI-generated work.

4. **Candidate Discovery and Resume Review**
   Apply employer-provided job requirements and screening criteria to fictional candidate information, identify potentially transferable skills, and support consistent human review without replacing employer decision-making.

5. **Practical HR and Office Applications**
   Draft job descriptions, interview questions, onboarding materials, internal communications, meeting summaries, policies, and training outlines.

6. **Improving Efficiency and Consistency**
   Identify repetitive tasks where AI assistance could reduce workload, improve consistency, and support faster completion.

7. **Privacy, Risk, and Human Oversight**
   Address confidential information, bias, inaccurate output, organizational policies, and employee accountability.

8. **Measuring Business and Economic Impact**
   Consider time savings, administrative capacity, process quality, hiring delays, and avoidable costs.

9. **Guided Practice and Implementation Planning**
   Complete exercises using fictional information and select an appropriate, low-risk workplace application.

The expanded program could be delivered as:

- One full-day workshop
- Two half-day sessions
- Four two-hour sessions

Learning Outcomes

Participants will be able to:

- Distinguish among AI-assisted, AI-enabled, and AI-embedded applications.
- Recognize appropriate uses of generative AI in industrial HR and office settings.
- Write prompts that produce more useful business content.
- Use AI to draft, summarize, organize, compare, and revise information.
- Apply AI assistance to candidate discovery and resume-review activities.
- Identify confidential information that should not be entered into an AI tool.
- Evaluate AI-generated work for accuracy, bias, tone, and completeness.
- Select a practical, low-risk application to explore within their organization.

Outside the Course Scope

The course does not include:

- HRIS or applicant-tracking-system integration
- AI-embedded product selection or implementation
- Automated candidate scoring or employment decisions
- API connections or custom workflow development
- Processing actual employee or applicant records
- Organization-wide AI deployment

Core Business Value

> Helping understaffed industrial HR and administrative teams identify qualified candidates, reduce avoidable workload and hiring costs, and produce more consistent work through responsible employee-directed AI assistance.

Addressing the Feedback

- Different HR systems: The course would be platform-neutral and would not teach HRIS or applicant-tracking-system workflows.
- Confidential information: All exercises would use fictional resumes, employee scenarios, business records, and policies.
- Software availability: Activities would be designed around general AI capabilities rather than a required product. Instructor demonstrations could be used when participants do not have approved tool access.
- Technical concerns: The course is intentionally centered on practical employee use, not integrations, APIs, workflow development, or system administration.
- Instructor credibility: An experienced HR professional could serve as a co-facilitator, curriculum reviewer, or guest contributor.
- Broader demand: Although HR remains a primary audience, the course would also apply to administrative, operations, and other office professionals.